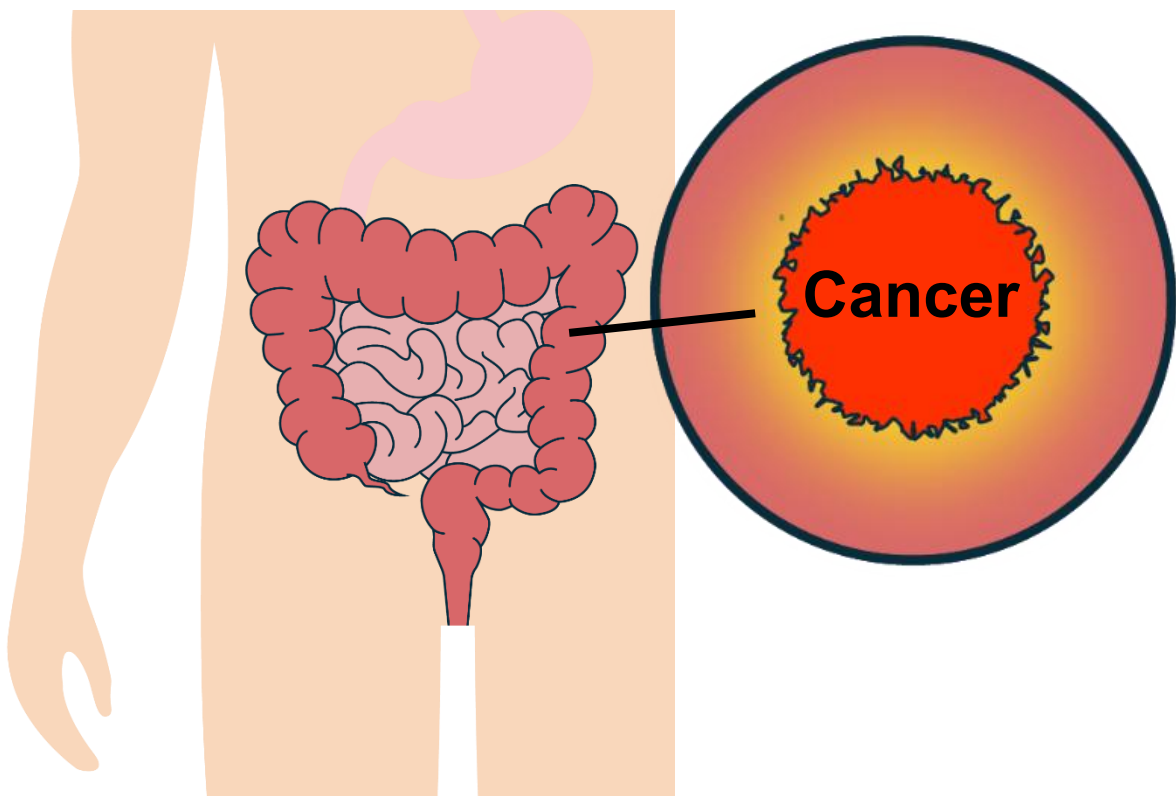




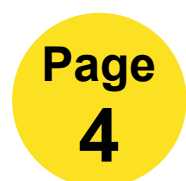
Facts about bowel cancer



What is in this booklet



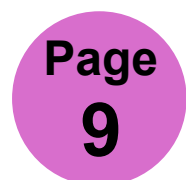
About the bowel



The facts about bowel cancer



Symptoms of bowel cancer



Bowel cancer screening

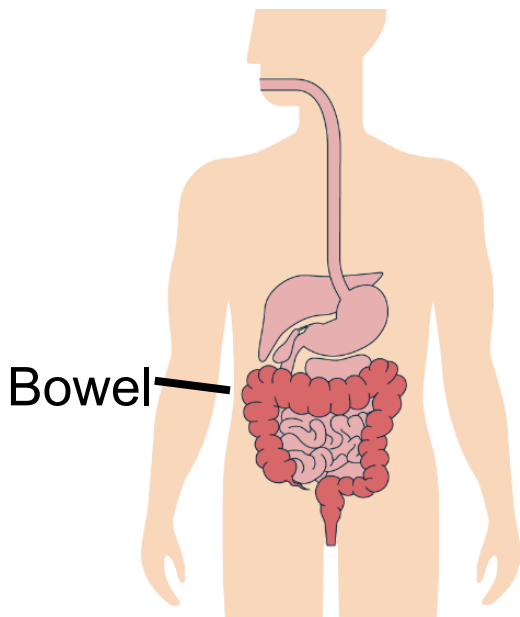


Risk factors

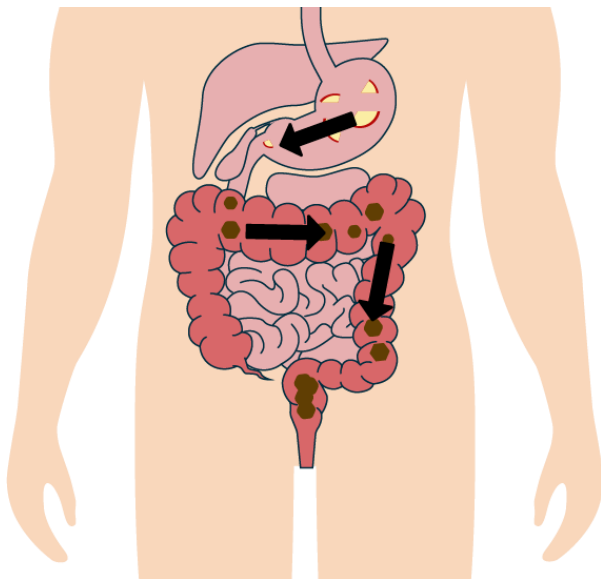


More information

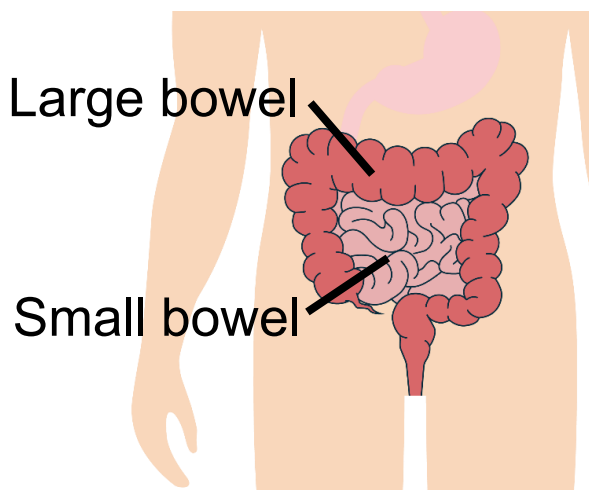
About the bowel



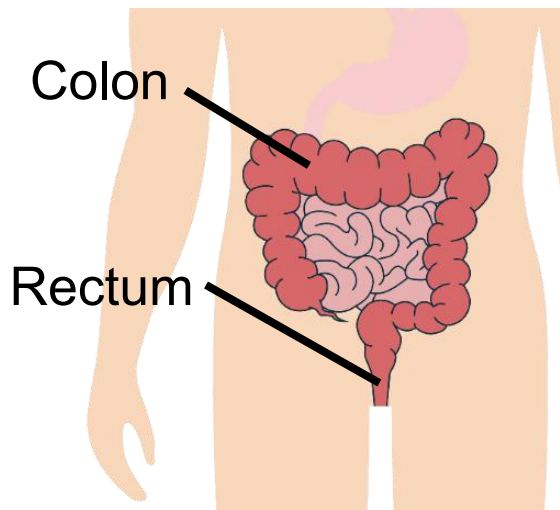
The bowel is part of digestive system.



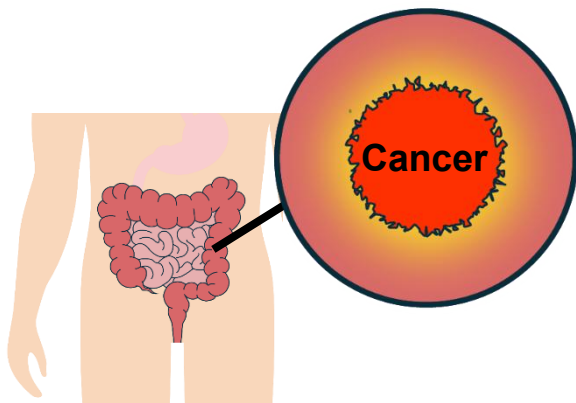
Food moves from your stomach into the bowel where it is turned into poo.



The bowel is a long wiggly tube. It is made of two parts called the small bowel and the large bowel.



The large bowel is made of two parts called the colon and the rectum.



Bowel cancer starts in the large bowel.

The facts about bowel cancer



When bowel cancer is found early there are lots of treatments for it.



Most people with bowel cancer live longer if it is found early.



Most people with bowel cancer die quickly if it is found later on.

Symptoms of bowel cancer



Your body shows signs when you're not well. These are called symptoms.

The symptoms of bowel cancer are:



Bleeding from your bottom.



Blood in your poo.



Needing to poo more often.



Having a runny poo. This is called diarrhoea.



Finding it hard to poo. This is called constipation.



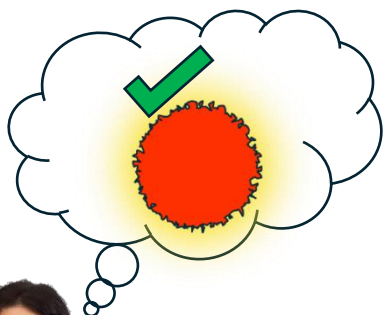
Losing weight but you do not know why.



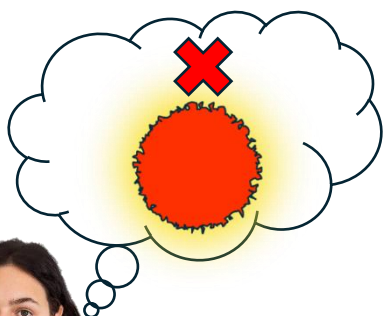
Feeling more tired but you do not know why.



Having a pain or a lump in your tummy.

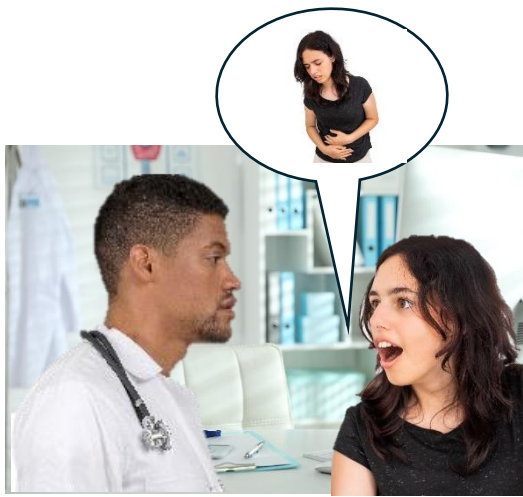


If you have any of these symptoms you might have bowel cancer.



The symptoms could be caused by other things that might not be cancer.





It is important to talk to your doctor if you have any of these symptoms.



The doctor can give you a test to do at home.



You can ask for Easy Read instructions for the test.

Bowel cancer screening



There is a test you can do to check if you have bowel cancer.



Bowel cancer screening is a test that looks for blood in your poo.



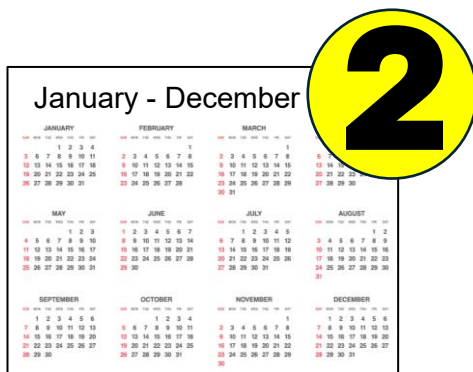
The test will be sent to your home. You do not need to ask for it.



If you live in England, Scotland or Wales, you will get a test in the post when you turn 50 years old.



If you live in Northern Ireland you will get a test in the post when you turn 60 years old.



You will get a test in the post every 2 years.

Risk factors



Risk factors are things that increase your risk of getting bowel cancer.

These include:



People in your family have had bowel cancer.

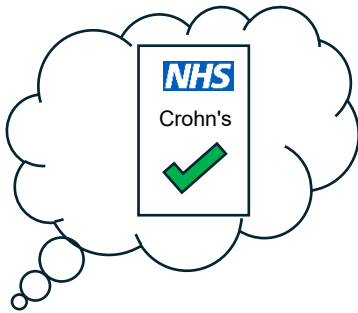


People in your family have had polyps. Polyps are small lumps in your bowel.



50+

You are older than 50.



You have another bowel condition like Crohn's disease or ulcerative colitis.

You can lower your change of getting bowel cancer by doing the following things:



Being a healthy body weight.



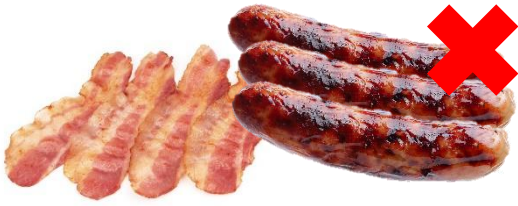
Moving more.



Drinking less alcohol.



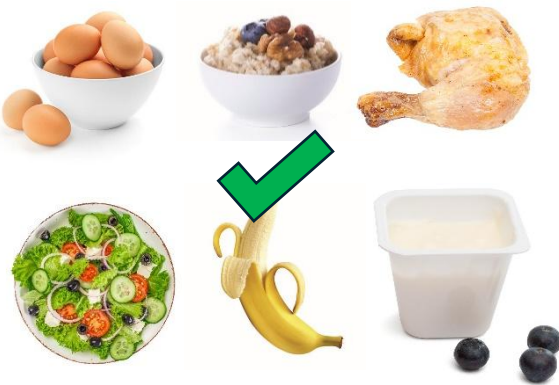
Not smoking.



Eating less processed meat.
This is things like bacon,
sausages and ham.



Eating less red meat. This is
things like beef, pork and
lamb.



Eating a healthy diet.



Doing your screening test
when it comes in the post



Visit **bowelcanceruk.org.uk** for information about bowel cancer.